

Problem 1. Nancowry (15 marks)

Nancowry (also known as Mūōt) is an Austronesian language spoken by around 950 people in the Nicobar Islands, India, specifically on the islands of Nancowry, Katchal and Kamorta.

Below are some words in Nancowry with possible English translations, given in a phonetic transcription. Note that **u**, **ə**, **ɛ**, **ia**, **ua**, **ua**, **uã**, **ã**, and **ẽ** are vowels; **ŋ**, **y**, and **ʔ** are consonants.

caluak	<i>to swallow</i>	teh	<i>to float</i>
fanue	<i>string</i>	tikoʔa	<i>something that is prodded</i>
hakuãt	<i>to hang (something) up</i>	tinkoʔ	<i>a prodding stick</i>
haneh	<i>an aeroplane</i>	tiyäh	<i>new</i>
harac	<i>to heat (something)</i>	top	<i>to drink (something)</i>
hata	<i>to level (something) out</i>	tumyäh	<i>to renew (something)</i>
hateha	<i>something that is floated</i>	ʔãŋ	<i>to cook (specifically, meat)</i>
haʔẽh	<i>to approach (something)</i>	ʔãŋa	<i>(some) cooked meat</i>
hinkuãt	<i>a hook (e.g. on a wall)</i>	ʔinttət	<i>a wipe</i>
humʔẽh	<i>to cause (something) to approach</i>	ʔittət	<i>to wipe (something)</i>
kanap	<i>a tooth</i>	fue	___(a)___
kapa	<i>something that is bitten</i>	fuea	___(b)___
kasu	<i>to trap (something)</i>	hapin	___(c)___
kintal	<i>a saw</i>	kuãt	___(d)___
pahuaʔ	<i>to fear, be scared</i>	haruuk	___(e)___
paloʔ	<i>loose</i>	___(f)___	<i>a beverage</i>
pin	<i>thick</i>	___(g)___	<i>a cauldron</i>
pumhuaʔa	<i>a scared person</i>	___(h)___	<i>a cup</i>
pumloʔ	<i>to loosen (something)</i>	___(i)___	<i>to float (something)</i>
rac	<i>hot</i>	___(j)___	<i>to fly</i>
ranuuk	<i>a vehicle</i>	___(k)___	<i>to make (something) prod</i>
ruuk	<i>to arrive</i>	___(l)___	<i>near</i>
sahuang	<i>cool</i>	___(m)___	<i>to saw (e.g. wood)</i>
saput	<i>to turn (oneself) over</i>	___(n)___	<i>something loose</i>
sinhuan	<i>(some) ice</i>	___(o)___	<i>a throat</i>
sumhuan	<i>to cool (something) down</i>	___(p)___	<i>a trap</i>
ta	<i>level, flat</i>	___(q)___	<i>to turn (something) over</i>

Q 1.1 Fill in the gaps (a) – (q). In exactly one answer, you should be unable to deduce a particular letter. In this case, replace it with an **X**, e.g. “an**X**wer”.

Q 1.2 Below are four Nancowry words and their English translations in a random order:

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|--------------------|--|
| 1. kahay | q. <i>to feel empty (in the heart)</i> |
| 2. kumfec | r. <i>a file (tool)</i> |
| 3. mahelepa | s. <i>to make something tiny</i> |
| 4. tanian | t. <i>a thing that is made to fit</i> |

Determine the correct correspondences.

Problem 2. Sakata (20 marks)

Sakata (also known as Kisakata) is a Bantu language spoken by several thousand people in the Democratic Republic of Congo. It consists of several quite distinct dialects; this problem features the dialect spoken in the village of Bosobe in the 1980s.

Below are some Sakata sentences, with their English translations. Note that **ə** and **ü** are both vowels.

- | | |
|--|---|
| 1. Banka balülü bamwi bebil benini. | <i>The good women saw the big fields.</i> |
| 2. Banjir babibə badzo ibat lelülü. | <i>The bad men killed the good duck.</i> |
| 3. Keto ketita kejo ntaw ne banjir. | <i>The long snake heard the men's goat.</i> |
| 4. Mabat masinxunə ola moka mo munjir. | <i>The ducks wanted to eat the man's book.</i> |
| 5. Mva nekikə ne banka nejao otang. | <i>The women's little dog learnt to read.</i> |
| 6. Nə ala ipe le ibat lenini? | <i>Who ate the big duck's wing?</i> |
| 7. Munkar nejo nko ne bang. | <i>The woman heard the children's chicken.</i> |
| 8. Nko ibibə ila ncher i bang. | <i>The bad chickens ate the children's peanuts.</i> |
| 9. Bande bachunga ntaw ilülü. | <i>The white men bought the good goats.</i> |
| 10. Ntaw i banka ikwi o kebil ke munde. | <i>The women's goats went to the white man's field.</i> |
| 11. Nə amwi bena be bande? | <i>Who saw the white men's things?</i> |
| 12. Ngombe nekikə nemwi lecher lenini. | <i>The little cow saw the big peanut.</i> |

Q 2.1 Translate into English:

13. **Mva imwi ntaw nebibə.**
14. **Bang basinxunə ochunga ngombe nenini.**
15. **Munjir nekikə netang mekan melülü.**
16. **Nə adzo beto be munkar?**

Q 2.2 Translate into Sakata:

17. *The cows heard the big dogs.*
18. *The white man learnt to eat wings.*
19. *Who bought the children's little thing?*
20. *The snakes of the field read the big books.*

Q 2.3 Explain your solution.

Problem 3. Kickapoo (20 marks)

Kickapoo is an Algonquian language spoken by approx. 1,000 people in Oklahoma, USA and Coahuila, Mexico. Kickapoo whistle speech is a substitute for spoken Kickapoo using whistles. It was once used for communication during courtship in Coahuila. Below are some numbers and other words, given both in spoken and whistled Kickapoo. The English meaning is also given for interest, but is not relevant to the solution of the problem.

Note: in spoken Kickapoo, mark ' over a vowel indicates an accented syllable; **θ** = *th* in *bath*; two adjacent vowels are part of the same syllable. In whistled Kickapoo, **o** represents a mora (a “beat”) of a whistled note; the marks ' and ` on a mora indicate high and low pitch, respectively; **q** indicates a silence with glottal closure between notes; **h** indicates a transition between notes that can be a silence without glottal closure, a volume change, articulation with friction, or a pitch glide.

Spoken	Whistled	English	Spoken	Whistled	English
nékoti	óqòqóò	<i>one</i>	nenohotáweewa	óhòqóhòòhóò	<i>he heard him</i>
níiswi	óòhóò	<i>two</i>	kíaskweepieníani	__(e)__	<i>he is drunk</i>
néθwihi	óhòhóò	<i>three</i>	áikaaθoníani	óòqòòhóhóòhóò	<i>he is pictured</i>
níewi	óòhóò	<i>four</i>	nesíanaateθikwéeni	__(f)__	<i>he must be awful</i>
níananwi	óóhòhóò	<i>five</i>	oθáaskwaanéhkwéya	òhóòqóóhóqòhóò	<i>his shoes</i>
nekotwáasika	óqóqóóhòqóò	<i>six</i>	nemiináaki	óhóóhóòqóò	<i>I gave it to them</i>
nóohika	óóhòqóò	<i>seven</i>	kemoopíimwaaki	__(g)__	<i>in your car</i>
neswáasika	òhóóhòqóò	<i>eight</i>	pakáanani	__(h)__	<i>pecans</i>
sáaka	óòqóò	<i>nine</i>	oθeθeehwáahi	__(i)__	<i>their brothers</i>
metáaθwi	__(a)__	<i>ten</i>	nesáeθípena	òhóòhóqòhóò	<i>we are hungry</i>
niiswaaþítaki	__(b)__	<i>twenty</i>	nemeskoθípena	__(j)__	<i>we are red</i>
máhwaha	__(c)__	<i>a bear</i>	nenakamópena	__(k)__	<i>we sang</i>
níihtiiθe	óóqòòhóò	<i>darling</i>	nenemaθópena	óhóhòhóqòhóò	<i>we stood</i>
piitíkeeno	__(d)__	<i>enter!</i>	kekoohkoosemwáaki	__(l)__	<i>your pigs</i>
asikáθoona	òhóqóhòòhóò	<i>sock</i>	eehkatáinaahkwéeki	òòqóqóòhòòqóòqóò	<i>when it was almost noon</i>

Q 3.1 Fill in the gaps (a)–(l) in the table above.

Q 3.2 Some linguists believe that the old word for seven in Kickapoo was ***niiswáasika**. What would this have been in whistled speech?

Q 3.3 Explain your solution.

Problem 4. Nganasan (20 marks)

Nganasan is a Uralic language spoken by the Nganasan people. Traditionally they have been the northernmost people in Eurasia, living in the Taimyr Peninsula, although today only around 470 Nganasan remain there, and fewer still speak the language.

Below are some Nganasan words written in a phonetic transcription, with their English translations given in alphabetical order. Note that **ð** = *th* in *this*, **d'** ≈ *j* in *judge*, **j** = *y* in *yes*; **č**, **ń**, **ŋ**, and **ʔ** are consonants; **ə**, **ü**, and **i** are vowels. Traditional Nganasan mythology includes several **ŋuəʔ** or gods, such as **bəndubtuə ŋuə** and **ńilitiə ŋuə**. The Nganasan people made small wooden idols, some of which would be kept in family homes, and offered them gifts to help please the gods.

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|------------------------|------------------------------------|
| 1. bad'ačimi | a. <i>aeroplane</i> |
| 2. bad'aʔbəbə | b. <i>boat</i> |
| 3. čimiʔ | c. <i>branches</i> |
| 4. d'üðübad'aʔ | d. <i>churches</i> |
| 5. d'üəbəbə | e. <i>earring</i> |
| 6. d'ütü | f. <i>gunpowder sack</i> |
| 7. huaad'ütüʔ | g. <i>hand</i> |
| 8. kojkəʔ | h. <i>hook</i> |
| 9. kojküʔmaðəʔ | i. <i>idols</i> |
| 10. koubasa | j. <i>purse</i> |
| 11. maðəʔ | k. <i>rings (for your fingers)</i> |
| 12. ŋənduj | l. <i>steamboats</i> |
| 13. təiriŋənduj | m. <i>stove</i> |
| 14. tuuŋəntuʔ | n. <i>teeth</i> |
| 15. tuusan | o. <i>tents</i> |

Q 4.1 Determine the correct correspondences between the words 1–15 and the words/phrases a–o.

Q 4.2 What is the literal translation of the Nganasan word **kojküʔmaðəʔ**?

Q 4.3 Translate into English:

16. **bəbəʔ**

17. **kojkə**

18. **kouʔ**

Q 4.4 Translate into Nganasan:

19. *boats*

20. *fires*

21. *(piece of) metal*

Q 4.5 Suggest a Nganasan translation of the phrase *forest fire*.

Problem 5. Kavalan (25 marks)

Different languages use different strategies to focus on particular words in the sentence. For example, English speakers change their tone of voice to emphasize a particular word: *Mary drank the water* and *Mary drank the water* have different meanings. You can even extract the subject for extra emphasis: *Mary, she drank the water*. Other languages have different strategies.

Kavalan is a critically endangered language spoken in Taiwan. As of 2000 it only had 24 remaining speakers, most of whom were elderly. Below are some sentences in Kavalan in a simplified transcription, along with their English translations. Focused words or phrases are underlined.

qasirr ya tiapzangawcia	<i><u>That crab</u> is fast.</i>
tmaytaiku tu rrutung	<i><u>I</u> see the monkey.</i>
qananti na sunisku ya liuqay qamasimna	<i>My child begins to eat <u>his rotten sour orange</u>.</i>
ipirisu ni	<i>Do you hear?</i>
ipiransu ya taquzay lamuku	<i>You hear <u>my sleeping village</u>.</i>
tikiskisku tu tarreb ya sarriqsu	<i>I cut the box with <u>your knife</u>.</i>
tmataktiina tu rasung ta buqankuan	<i><u>He</u> begins to dig the well in my sand.</i>
qman tu kitutay taquq ya wasucia ta Kalinkuan	<i><u>That dog</u> eats the small chicken in Hualien.</i>
liuq ya qamasim	<i><u>The sour orange</u> is rotten.</i>
tipukunti na suniscia tu taquq ya tunun	<i>That child begins to hit the chicken with <u>the stick</u>.</i>
tatakan na wasuku ya rasung	<i>My dog digs <u>the well</u>.</i>
tmutun tu krisiwcia ya tazungan ni	<i>Does <u>the woman</u> burn that money?</i>
rrasaansu ya rrutungcia ni	<i>Do you buy <u>that monkey</u>?</i>
taytaannati ya busarray wasuta	<i>He begins to see our white dog.</i>
busarr ya buqan ta Taypakan ni	<i>Is <u>the sand</u> white in Taipei?</i>
titaytasu tu kitutay lamu ya matasu	<i>You see the small village with <u>your eyes</u>.</i>

Q 5.1 Translate the following sentences into English, indicating the focused words or phrases by underlining:

1. taquz ya rrutungna
2. tutunan na tazungan ya Taypak ni
3. tirrasana tu tatakay taquqku ya krisiwta
4. kmiskistiita tu kitutay qamasim ta lamuciaan

Q 5.2 Translate the following sentences into Kavalan:

5. Am I small?
6. His eating child hears your fast dog.
7. Does our crab begin to sleep in that box?
8. We begin to dig the well with my knife.
9. You begin to see that monkey in the well.

Q 5.3 Explain your solution.